Rejoice in the Lord Always

Philippians 4:4-13 (KJV)

Scripture

Philippians 4:4-13

[4] Rejoice in the Lord alway: and again I say, Rejoice. [5] Let your moderation be known unto all men. The Lord is at hand. [6] Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God. [7] And the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus. [8] Finally, brethren, whatsoever things are true, whatsoever things are honest, whatsoever things are just, whatsoever things are pure, whatsoever things are lovely, whatsoever things are of good report; if there be any virtue, and if there be any praise, think on these things. [9] Those things, which ye have both learned, and received, and heard, and seen in me, do: and the God of peace shall be with you. [10] But I rejoiced in the Lord greatly, that now at the last your care of me hath flourished again; wherein ye were also careful, but ye lacked opportunity. [11] Not that I speak in respect of want: for I have learned, in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content. [12] I know both how to be abased, and I know how to abound: every where and in all things I am instructed both to be full and to be hungry, both to abound and to suffer need. [13] I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me.

Outline

1. Rejoice in the Lord, always

Rejoice in the _____ alway.

Our joy rests on who God is, not on our _____.

Read: Philippians 4:4-5; Nehemiah 8:10; Habakkuk 3:17-18

2. Pray instead of worrying

Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by _____ and supplication.

The peace of God shall _____ your hearts and minds.

Read: Philippians 4:6-9; 1 Peter 5:7; Matthew 6:31-34

3. Learn contentment through Christ's strength

I have _____, in whatsoever state I am, therewith to be content.

I can do all things through _____ which strengtheneth me.

Read: Philippians 4:11-13; 1 Timothy 6:6-8; Hebrews 13:5

Discussion questions

1. How is "rejoicing in the Lord" different from simply being happy?

2. What is the difference between caring about something and being anxious about it?

3. Why do you think Paul says contentment is "learned"?

4. Why might prosperity test our hearts as much as hardship does?

This week

Each time you notice yourself worrying this week, stop and turn it into a short prayer, ending with one thing you are thankful for. Write down any worries you prayed about, and at the end of the week, note how God gave you peace.